

Toby Claxton

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Computer Science BSc, Queen's University Belfast (**Russell Group**), **First Class Honours**

Professional Summary:

Builder at heart with a lot of love for bringing ideas from conception to fully fledged products. **In past ventures I have raised a combined £85k in Northern Irish VC and angel funding.** Expert in Go, Typescript and the Laravel ecosystem, with deep technical roots in cloud-native DevOps (Kubernetes, Terraform) gained from working on enterprise-scale infrastructure at Rapid 7. Recently I've been at CineArk driving AI strategy, I combine an executive eye with SC-eligibility to build high-utility, automated business solutions.

- **Professional Ventures:** Canvassr, GrantGunner
- **Languages:** Go, Typescript, Python, JavaScript (VueJS & React), PHP (Laravel)
- **Infrastructure:** AWS, GCP, Azure, Terraform, Kubernetes, Docker
- **Data/DevOps:** MySQL, Redis, Linux CLI, Git, CI/CD, Spinnaker, Jenkins

Professional Experience

AI Implementation Executive Assoc. at [CineArk](#), London

March 2026

- Working hand-in-glove with department heads to introduce AI into their workflows in an impactful manner. In just 1 month of starting CineArk had a few new toys:
 - A bespoke global production tracker to scrape and enrich crew from IMDB, Production Bulletin and Guild to gather crew connections for upcoming movies and TV shows which doubled the no. of warm leads for the outreach team.
 - A RAG chatbot that hooked up to Current RMS's inventory tracker and slack channels they use for support.
 - A variety of Zapier flows to streamline their processes while also keeping the workflow accessible to the team using it.

– Present

Co-founder [Canvassr](#), London

May 2024 –

- Raised £85K from angel tickets and a pre-seed NI fund called Techstart LLP to build a gig work platform for face-to-face sales. Worked closely with telecom companies like MET Connections and charities from Cerebra to Greek Stray Rescue. Largely shuttered due to issues with recruitment.

Dec 2025

Software Engineer (Intern to SE1) [Rapid7](#), Belfast Office

June 2023 –

- Was part of a globally distributed team. Helped engineer distributed systems in Go and Spring Boot, leveraging Kubernetes, Terraform, and Spinnaker to migrate 10,000+ on-premise integrations and onboard hundreds of enterprise customers to a cloud-native log collection platform.

May 2024

Early Career

2020–2023

- I spent each summer during my university years working on my Uncle's farm at Mourne Grange down in Kilkeel, doing manual labour like laying patios, shoveling hay, and building fences.

Personal Projects



Seidkona – Stealth mode

- Building a geopolitical analysis tool in my spare time. It offers various lenses to see the world through the eyes of the most prominent geopolitical commentators of our time, and also wargames potential scenarios like conflicts and geological events like the AMOC collapse and considers downstream effects on equity markets.



GrantGunner (www.grantgunner.org) – January 2026

- Architected and launched an AI-agent SaaS platform (Laravel/Vue.js) that scrapes and parses global funding data, maintaining a real-time database of 10,000s of grants and funds to automate discovery and application drafting for non-profits and startups. Built with Terraform, Inertia.js, Laravel and TailwindCSS. Growth has largely stalled, not significant enough to raise.



RapidResearch – Nov 2023 to May 2024

- Worked with the University of New South Wales to build an AI research SaaS tool that saved researchers months of time. It does this by automating the screening process of 1000s of papers that is typically manually done in literature/scoping reviews using Google's Gemini models and machine AI parsing tools like Grobid.



VidGaze – Sep 2021 to June 2023

- Launched an online video streaming platform where users can watch content from YouTube, Twitch, Odysee, Vimeo, and Dailymotion in one place. Built with AWS, Apify, Blade templates, custom scrapers and OAuth 2.0.

Educational Attainments

Queen's University Belfast (Russell Group)

- BSc Computer Science | **First Class Honours (1st)**
- *Dissertation "Client Security and Orchestration in a Hostile Physical Environment"*

Ballyclare High School

- **A-Levels:** Chemistry (A*), Maths (A), Biology (A).
- **GCSEs:** 8A*, 2As
- **Violin:** Grade 8 Distinction

Hobbies

Beyond engineering, I am a dedicated Parkrun enthusiast, valuing the discipline of endurance running and the community-building aspect of the weekly event. My interest extends to tabletop board games, my favourite being Eclipse.